

Also, the mobile station is continuously on the alert for alternative access points. The software solutions provide for session persistence. External roaming occurs when a mobile station moves into a WLAN of another wireless internet service provider (WISP) and takes their service. For using the wireless service provided by a foreign network (which is not the user's home network), it has to be open for visitors and there will be special authentication and billing systems for such mobile services.

Hotspots

a hotspot is a physical location that offers internet access over a wireless LAN through the use of a shared internet connection and a single router. There are many hotspot locations available in the west, but in India, the concept is yet to take off. However, there are several academic institutions that have WLAN enabled and serve as a hotspot. Anyone can use a laptop or a Wi-Fi phone or any other portable device to access Wi-Fi. There are several locations which have broadband enabled internet access. Procuring a wireless router, interfacing it and getting access to the internet then becomes simple.

The next time you sit in a coffee shop, check if it has a free hotspot

Free hotspots operate in two ways. One is to use the open public network. One Wi-Fi router and then private users of wireless routers can turn off their authentication, thus opening their connection, allowing anyone in range to share. Certain closed public networks use a hotspot management system to control and allow only specific users to access the internet, or maybe restrict individual downloading capability or charge per minute for downloaded information. Bandwidth restriction is also possible. A specific type of closed public network is a commercial hotspot. For certain places where authentication and/or payment is required, there are proper authentication, user level access enabled systems. Software solutions are also available for this. Though some restaurants, lounges, airports provide Wi-Fi access as part of customer service, you are likely to be charged for using the internet in other places.

In the early 2000s, when Wi-Fi usage was starting to boom,